



Cambridge IGCSE™

BIOLOGY

0610/63

Paper 6 Alternative to Practical

October/November 2023

MARK SCHEME

Maximum Mark: 40

Published

This mark scheme is published as an aid to teachers and candidates, to indicate the requirements of the examination. It shows the basis on which Examiners were instructed to award marks. It does not indicate the details of the discussions that took place at an Examiners' meeting before marking began, which would have considered the acceptability of alternative answers.

Mark schemes should be read in conjunction with the question paper and the Principal Examiner Report for Teachers.

Cambridge International will not enter into discussions about these mark schemes.

Cambridge International is publishing the mark schemes for the October/November 2023 series for most Cambridge IGCSE, Cambridge International A and AS Level components, and some Cambridge O Level components.

This document consists of **8** printed pages.

PUBLISHED**Generic Marking Principles**

These general marking principles must be applied by all examiners when marking candidate answers. They should be applied alongside the specific content of the mark scheme or generic level descriptors for a question. Each question paper and mark scheme will also comply with these marking principles.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 1:

Marks must be awarded in line with:

- the specific content of the mark scheme or the generic level descriptors for the question
- the specific skills defined in the mark scheme or in the generic level descriptors for the question
- the standard of response required by a candidate as exemplified by the standardisation scripts.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 2:

Marks awarded are always **whole marks** (not half marks, or other fractions).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 3:

Marks must be awarded **positively**:

- marks are awarded for correct/valid answers, as defined in the mark scheme. However, credit is given for valid answers which go beyond the scope of the syllabus and mark scheme, referring to your Team Leader as appropriate
- marks are awarded when candidates clearly demonstrate what they know and can do
- marks are not deducted for errors
- marks are not deducted for omissions
- answers should only be judged on the quality of spelling, punctuation and grammar when these features are specifically assessed by the question as indicated by the mark scheme. The meaning, however, should be unambiguous.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 4:

Rules must be applied consistently, e.g. in situations where candidates have not followed instructions or in the application of generic level descriptors.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 5:

Marks should be awarded using the full range of marks defined in the mark scheme for the question (however; the use of the full mark range may be limited according to the quality of the candidate responses seen).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 6:

Marks awarded are based solely on the requirements as defined in the mark scheme. Marks should not be awarded with grade thresholds or grade descriptors in mind.

Science–Specific Marking Principles

- 1 Examiners should consider the context and scientific use of any keywords when awarding marks. Although keywords may be present, marks should not be awarded if the keywords are used incorrectly.
- 2 The examiner should not choose between contradictory statements given in the same question part, and credit should not be awarded for any correct statement that is contradicted within the same question part. Wrong science that is irrelevant to the question should be ignored.
- 3 Although spellings do not have to be correct, spellings of syllabus terms must allow for clear and unambiguous separation from other syllabus terms with which they may be confused (e.g. ethane / ethene, glucagon / glycogen, refraction / reflection).
- 4 The error carried forward (ecf) principle should be applied, where appropriate. If an incorrect answer is subsequently used in a scientifically correct way, the candidate should be awarded these subsequent marking points. Further guidance will be included in the mark scheme where necessary and any exceptions to this general principle will be noted.
- 5 'List rule' guidance

For questions that require ***n*** responses (e.g. State **two** reasons ...):
 - The response should be read as continuous prose, even when numbered answer spaces are provided.
 - Any response marked *ignore* in the mark scheme should not count towards ***n***.
 - Incorrect responses should not be awarded credit but will still count towards ***n***.
 - Read the entire response to check for any responses that contradict those that would otherwise be credited. Credit should **not** be awarded for any responses that are contradicted within the rest of the response. Where two responses contradict one another, this should be treated as a single incorrect response.
 - Non–contradictory responses after the first ***n*** responses may be ignored even if they include incorrect science.

6 Calculation specific guidance

Correct answers to calculations should be given full credit even if there is no working or incorrect working, **unless** the question states 'show your working'.

For questions in which the number of significant figures required is not stated, credit should be awarded for correct answers when rounded by the examiner to the number of significant figures given in the mark scheme. This may not apply to measured values.

For answers given in standard form (e.g. $a \times 10^n$) in which the convention of restricting the value of the coefficient (a) to a value between 1 and 10 is not followed, credit may still be awarded if the answer can be converted to the answer given in the mark scheme.

Unless a separate mark is given for a unit, a missing or incorrect unit will normally mean that the final calculation mark is not awarded. Exceptions to this general principle will be noted in the mark scheme.

7 Guidance for chemical equations

Multiples / fractions of coefficients used in chemical equations are acceptable unless stated otherwise in the mark scheme.

State symbols given in an equation should be ignored unless asked for in the question or stated otherwise in the mark scheme.

Mark scheme abbreviations

- ; separates marking points
- / alternative responses for the same marking point
- R reject the response
- A accept the response
- I ignore the response
- ecf error carried forward
- AVP any valid point
- ora or reverse argument
- AW alternative wording
- underline actual word given must be used by candidate (grammatical variants excepted)
- () the word / phrase in brackets is not required but sets the context

Question	Answer	Marks	Guidance
1(a)(i)	lines drawn on each cup that would intersect the dough line if drawn all the way across ;	1	
1(a)(ii)	table drawn with minimum two columns and a header line ; appropriate column / row headings with units if appropriate ; three heights recorded ;	3	e.g. cup and change in (dough) height / mm
1(a)(iii)	as temperature increases (the rate of) respiration increases / ora ;	1	
1(a)(iv)	temperature ;	1	
1(a)(v)	dough was, rounded / not flat / not smooth / AW ;	1	
1(a)(vi)	(electronic) balance / measuring cylinder / AVP ;	1	
1(a)(vii)	to equilibrate the water / so that the water is the same temperature as the water-baths ;	1	
1(a)(viii)	<i>any one from:</i> 1 (initial height of dry ingredients is 1 cm so) the initial amount / mass / volume, of dough is different in each cup ; 2 proportion of water to flour and yeast differs between cups ; 3 there are two independent variables ; 4 <i>idea</i> that the same increase in dough volume (during the investigation) will result in a different increase in height in the (3) cups / AW ;	1	
1(b)(i)	(brick-)red / AVP ;	1	
1(b)(ii)	<i>any one from:</i> heating (the reagent, risk described) ; Benedict's reagent is, toxic / harmful / irritant / corrosive ;	1	

Question	Answer	Marks	Guidance
1(b)(iii)	limewater / AVP ;	1	
1(b)(iv)	(–)94.3(%) ;;;	3	MP1 selection of correct values from table i.e. 5.3 and 0.3 <u>only</u> MP2 correct calculation for percentage decrease $(5.3 - 0.3) \div 5.3 \times 100$ or $100 - ((0.3 / 5.3) \times 100)$ = -94.339622641509 MP3 correct rounding to one decimal place ecf from previous step
1(c)	<i>independent variable:</i> 1 at least two different exercise intensities ; <i>dependent variable:</i> 2 breathing rate (immediately) after /during exercising ; <i>detail of the method:</i> 3 method of changing intensity of one type of exercise ; 4 measurement of initial / resting breathing rate ; 5 describing type of exercise / equipment used ; 6 & 7 from variables kept constant – max two from: ;; • same age participants • same sex participants • same fitness of participants • same duration of exercise / pace / speed of exercise • same person • same named environmental conditions e.g. temperature / humidity / gradient 8 two or more replicates / repeat investigation two or more times ; 9 safety precaution e.g. checking participants are healthy / checking for trip hazards / suitable footwear ;	6	

Question	Answer	Marks	Guidance
2(a)(i)	outline us a single clear line with no shading ; size of the guard cell width is at least 31 mm ; detail 1: at least four nuclei, 2 roughly circular (epidermal) and 2 longer than wide (guard cells) ; detail 2: <u>only</u> two epidermal cells touching each other and touching two guard cells ;	4	
2(a)(ii)	line PQ length: 31 ± 1 (mm) ; 0.019 (mm) ;;	3	MP1 correct measurement of line PQ MP2 correct calculation MP3 correct rounding of answer to two significant figures line PQ of 30 mm = 0.018 line PQ of 32 mm = 0.019 ecf from previous step
2(b)(i)	distance (air bubble) moved, in five minutes / in a set time ;	1	
2(b)(ii)	<i>any two from:</i> temperature ; same potometer ; number of leaves ; humidity ; time (measured) ;	2	
2(b)(iii)	airtight seal / prevent water loss / AW ;	1	
2(b)(iv)	to identify anomalous results ;	1	

Question	Answer	Marks	Guidance
2(b)(v)	1 axes labelled with units to match table headers ; 2 suitable scale and occupies at least half the grid in both directions ; 3 all five plots plotted accurately $\pm$ half a small square ; 4 suitable line drawn ;	4	wind speed km / hour and distance (the air bubble) moved in 5 minutes / mm
2(b)(vi)	value from candidate's graph (mm) ; indications on graph as to where reading taken ;	2	